Ridley Road Market

1 Ridley Road Market is in Dalston, a short walk from Dalston Kingsland station. It is one of the oldest street markets in Hackney. Every morning, traders set up their stalls along the narrow street.

2 You can buy fresh fruit and vegetables, fish, meat, colourful fabrics and cheap things for the kitchen. Many stalls sell food from Africa, the Caribbean and Turkey, so it is a good place to find ingredients from home.

3 The market is busy and noisy. Traders shout loudly to tell people about their prices, and music comes from some of the shops. Prices are usually lower than in the supermarket, especially at the end of the day, when traders want to sell everything quickly.

4 Bring cash, because some small stalls do not take cards. Go early if you want the best fish. Walk carefully when it rains – the ground can be slippery.

You are the expert for this place.

1 Read the text alone.

2 On your question sheet, answer the questions for your place only.

3 Underline the words in the text that prove each answer. Write the question number next to them.

4 Check with your group. Keep this text: in your new group, read your underlined words aloud to prove your answers. Don’t show the text.

London Fields and the Lido

1 London Fields is a large green park between Hackney Central and Broadway Market. On sunny days it is full of people. Families have picnics on the grass, children play happily in the playground, and friends play football or table tennis. There is also a special area where you can have a barbecue.

2 At one side of the park is London Fields Lido, an outdoor swimming pool. It is 50 metres long and the water is heated, so people swim there all year – even in December! The lido is not free, and on busy days it is a good idea to book online. If you are not a strong swimmer, use the slow lane and swim calmly.

3 The park is free and open every day. In winter it gets dark early, so walk home with a friend in the evening.

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Broadway Market

1 Broadway Market is a street near London Fields and the Regent's Canal. During the week it is a quiet street with small shops, cafés and a bookshop. But every Saturday it changes completely. More than a hundred stalls fill the road, and thousands of people come from all over London.

2 The Saturday market is famous for food. You can buy fresh bread, cheese, cakes and flowers, or eat hot food from many different countries. The food is delicious, but it is often expensive – a coffee and a cake can cost eight or nine pounds. If you want to save money, walk slowly along the street first and look at all the prices before you buy.

3 The market gets very crowded after eleven o'clock, so try to arrive early. It is a nice walk from London Fields, and you can sit by the canal to eat.

You are the expert for this place.

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The Regent’s Canal

1 The Regent’s Canal runs through Hackney, past Broadway Market and Victoria Park. Next to the water there is a path, called the towpath, where you can walk or ride a bike. It is free and open all the time, and it is one of the most peaceful places in the borough.

2 On the canal you will see narrowboats – long, thin boats painted in bright colours. Some people live on these boats all year. You will also see ducks, swans and sometimes a heron standing very still in the water.

3 The towpath is narrow, so be polite. Cyclists should ride slowly and ring their bell when they come up behind people. Walkers should keep to one side. Do not feed bread to the ducks – it is bad for them. On a sunny afternoon, it is lovely to walk all the way from Hackney to Islington.

You are the expert for this place.

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